championed the need for the highest standards of business integrity and a code of conduct that would be beyond suspicion or reproach. Shroff was conscious that the lobbying for free enterprise could be misused by unscrupulous businessmen and formulated a code of conduct to be followed by all those engaged in free enterprise, ranging from businessman to doctors, lawyers and journalists. He felt that until malpractices were eradicated, the case for free enterprise would continue to suffer.

It was also at the Forum that Shroff started his practice of making post-budget speeches analysing the Union Budget. Shroff used to deliver the speech at Green's Hotel (next to the Taj Mahal Hotel) in Bombay. One of the Forum's discoveries was Nani Palkhivala, who first spoke at the Forum in December 1957, and greatly impressed Shroff. Palkhivala went on to deliver his first post-budget analysis soon after, speeches which soon became the stuff of legend.

Minoo Shroff recalls that his uncle, one of the original venture capitalists of India, was a warm hearted and generous person, ever willing to help deserving individuals and worthy causes not only with his time, but also with his own resources. Shroff actively helped a large number of talented entrepreneurs to set up and develop their enterprises and encouraged traders to start new industries. When the author asked Minoo Shroff what struck him the most about his famous uncle, he was quick to reply: 'His brilliance and his courage.'[4] The one trait that Shroff, pioneering financier, libertarian, and patriot, will always be remembered for was his unflinching faith in individual freedom, private initiative and enterprise, democratic traditions and values, all of which he defended with singular passion and vigour.

Shroff passed away on October 27, 1965, after succumbing to a massive heart attack. His death removed one of the most colourful and remarkable personalities from the financial and industrial scene of India.



A distinguishing feature of an institution builder is his ability to select the right men. One of those whom Shroff supported and mentored in the newly formed ICICI was H.T. Parekh, then a broker with the firm of Harkisondass Lukhmidass. Shroff was instrumental in supporting H.T. Parekh and later promoting him as General Manager. Parekh, the founder of HDFC, and